

August 30, 2026

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing in support of Aditya Patil, who recently completed a cybersecurity co-op on my vulnerability management team before returning to school for the final semester of his master's program. I supervised his work directly. I recommend him without reservation, and I would hire him.

Technical depth. Aditya worked across the full range of application and product security assessment rather than a slice of it. He used our vulnerability management tool suite to reduce exposure across the environment, but he did not stop where the tooling stopped — he performed manual penetration testing, reviewed code, and assessed the design and architecture of new initiatives before they were built. That last part matters more than it sounds. Most people entering this field can operate a scanner and interpret its output. Far fewer can read a proposed design and identify where it will be weak, and fewer still will raise it early, while a fix is still inconvenient rather than expensive. Aditya did that consistently, and his SAST and DAST work was backed by the code review needed to separate real findings from noise.

Communicating risk, and closing it. The hard part of vulnerability management is not discovery. It is persuading the people who own the systems to act. Aditya presented findings so that engineering teams understood not only what was wrong but why it mattered and what to do about it, and he adjusted that framing for stakeholders who needed the business consequence rather than the technical detail. The outcome I measure is remediation, not report volume — and findings he raised got fixed. He followed them through to closure instead of handing off a list.

Working in a regulated environment. Our environment is subject to HIPAA and handles protected health information, on systems that cannot simply be taken offline to accommodate a test. Aditya understood those constraints early and worked within them without having to be steered toward them. He was careful about scope, careful about data, and disciplined about the difference between what he was authorized to do and what was technically possible. In a regulated setting that judgment is not optional, and it is not something I can teach quickly. He arrived with it.

Ramp-up, reliability, and ambiguity. He became productive faster than I expected. More valuable than raw speed: when I handed him work that was genuinely undefined — a new initiative with no settled scope and no established review process — he did not return with questions and wait. He returned with a proposed scope, a method, and a recommendation, and his reasoning held up under scrutiny consistently enough that I came to trust it by default. He is a self-starter in the meaningful sense of the term: he finds the work, defines it, and finishes it.

I have supervised a number of co-ops and early-career engineers. Aditya is at the top of that group. He performed above the expectations I set for the role, and much of what he did — architecture review, risk communication to non-technical stakeholders, sound judgment in a regulated environment — I would consider strong work from someone several years further along. He will be an asset to whoever hires him, and I expect he will outgrow the title he is given.

I am glad to speak directly with anyone considering him.

Sincerely,

Rich Ingersoll

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